SSC CHSL 2021 Tier-I question paper with answers

6 June 2022 · Shift 1

78 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +2 for a right answer, –0.50 for a wrong one

The other 22 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20220816140307/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/FinalAnswerKeys_%20CHSLE2021_16082022.pdf

English Language 22 questions

Q.1

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underline segment in the given sentence. His disease is no doubt very serious but he will “pull over”.

(A) pull through
(B) pull for
(C) pull against
(D) pull at

Q.4

Select the most appropriate synonym of the word given in the brackets to fill in the blank. Collection of money through illegal means without any hard work increased the _____ (greed) of the corrupt officials.

(A) cupidity
(B) stability
(C) curiosity
(D) reliability

Q.5

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Instanteneous
(B) Presumptuous
(C) Illegitimate
(D) Lascivious

Q.6

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. The mother loving looked / at her baby / as the nurse / brought her in.

(A) The mother loving looked
(B) brought her in
(C) at her baby
(D) as the nurse

Q.7

In the following passage, a word has been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Growing up in Bengaluru, I have watched the city grow and _____ at its seams, welcoming, as its own, all the _____ population in search of jobs and pleasant _____.

(A) retreat, native, food
(B) flex, migrant, weather
(C) curtail, local, destination
(D) demolish, foreign, tourism

Q.8

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Laconic

(A) Exaggerated
(B) Lengthy
(C) Talkative
(D) Concise

Q.9

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the underlined group of words. In this “situation of no organisation and control due to the lack of an effective government,” the rate of crime has increased exponentially.

(A) Autocracy
(B) Autonomy
(C) Anarchy
(D) Aristocracy

Q.10

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Annoy

(A) Comfort
(B) Miff
(C) Get
(D) Ruffle

Q.12

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. When we reached the hill station, it was raining “the heaviest”.

(A) heavily
(B) more heavy
(C) heavy
(D) most heavily

Q.13

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. Strong taste or liking for something

(A) Insolvent
(B) Parole
(C) Ebullient
(D) Penchant

Q.14

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Start from scratch

(A) Start it from the previous situation
(B) Start from the given line
(C) Start something fast to finish it before a particular time
(D) Start entirely from the beginning

Q.15

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Vain

(A) Loyal
(B) Modest
(C) Unfair
(D) Energetic

Q.16

Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice. Where can I find the way to the library?

(A) Where can they be found in the library?
(B) They cannot be found in the way to library?
(C) Where can the way to the library be found?
(D) Who can found with the way to library?

Q.17

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select ‘No substitution required’. They “didn’t ate” anything yesterday.

(A) No substitution required
(B) doesn’t eat
(C) didn’t eat
(D) hadn’t ate

Q.18

Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice. Premchand wrote this novel.

(A) This novel written by Premchand.
(B) That novel is by Premchand.
(C) This novel was written by Premchand.
(D) Premchand novel has been written by him.

Q.19

Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph. A.Holi is the festival of colours which is celebrated not only in India but all across the world. B.Then on the next day, people of all ages gather together to play with colours called 'gulal' and coloured water called 'Dulahandi'. C.People celebrate 'Holika Dahan' on the first day by gathering around and burning piles of wood and cow dung and singing bhajans related to Holi. D.It is also a festival of unity as it brings people together to celebrate a festival regardless of caste, ethnicity, or religion.

(A) ADCB
(B) ABCD
(C) DCBA
(D) ADBC

Q.20

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Resplendent

(A) Magnificent
(B) Astonished
(C) Enthusiastic
(D) Exuberant

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Our host started to read and the (1)_____ stopped. There was a sweet (2)_____ as each person read, not one that felt forced or imposed in any way. People did not seem to (3)_____ or cough, but perhaps that is just how I remember it now. I know I was increasingly self-conscious as the readings came closer to me and that when it was my turn I think I (4)_____ through most of it, probably without making any sense of the (5)_____.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) chatter
(B) fritter
(C) rattle
(D) patter

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Our host started to read and the (1)_____ stopped. There was a sweet (2)_____ as each person read, not one that felt forced or imposed in any way. People did not seem to (3)_____ or cough, but perhaps that is just how I remember it now. I know I was increasingly self-conscious as the readings came closer to me and that when it was my turn I think I (4)_____ through most of it, probably without making any sense of the (5)_____.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) chaos
(B) silence
(C) din
(D) noise

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Our host started to read and the (1)_____ stopped. There was a sweet (2)_____ as each person read, not one that felt forced or imposed in any way. People did not seem to (3)_____ or cough, but perhaps that is just how I remember it now. I know I was increasingly self-conscious as the readings came closer to me and that when it was my turn I think I (4)_____ through most of it, probably without making any sense of the (5)_____.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) sleep
(B) sing
(C) fidget
(D) distract

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Our host started to read and the (1)_____ stopped. There was a sweet (2)_____ as each person read, not one that felt forced or imposed in any way. People did not seem to (3)_____ or cough, but perhaps that is just how I remember it now. I know I was increasingly self-conscious as the readings came closer to me and that when it was my turn I think I (4)_____ through most of it, probably without making any sense of the (5)_____.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) played
(B) mumbled
(C) grumbled
(D) dozed

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Our host started to read and the (1)_____ stopped. There was a sweet (2)_____ as each person read, not one that felt forced or imposed in any way. People did not seem to (3)_____ or cough, but perhaps that is just how I remember it now. I know I was increasingly self-conscious as the readings came closer to me and that when it was my turn I think I (4)_____ through most of it, probably without making any sense of the (5)_____.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) poetry
(B) music
(C) dance
(D) pottery

General Intelligence 19 questions

Q.3

Which of the following numbers will replace the question mark (?) in the given series? 27,31,42,72,139,?

(A) 267
(B) 264
(C) 271
(D) 355

Q.4

Three statements are given, followed by three conclusions numbered I, II and III. Assuming the statements to be true, even if they seem to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: Some hexagons are rectangles. Some rectangles are decagons. All decagons are rhombuses. Conclusions: I. Some rhombuses are rectangles. II. Some rhombuses are hexagons. III. Some decagons are hexagons.

(A) Only conclusions I and II follow
(B) Only conclusion I follows
(C) Only conclusions I and III follow
(D) Only conclusion II follows

Q.5

Pointing to a lady in a photograph, Harsh said, “My wife’s son is the father of her mother’s daughter”. How is the lady related to Harsh?

(A) Mother
(B) Son’s daughter
(C) Daughter
(D) Sister

Q.6

Which letter-cluster will replace the question mark (?) to complete the given series? GJWC, JPFO, ?, PBXM, SHGY

(A) FAJR
(B) UVNS
(C) MVOA
(D) PQSE

Q.7

In a certain code language, 'RATE' is written as 'UDWH' and ‘RICH’ is written as ‘ULFK’. How will 'SAVE' be written in that language?

(A) VDYH
(B) VDWH
(C) VDVH
(D) VDUH

Q.9

Select the correct option that indicates the arrangement of the following words in a logical and meaningful order. 1- Eat 2- Fruit 3- Seed 4- Pluck 5- Plant

(A) 3,5,2,4,1
(B) 2,3,5,4,1
(C) 5,3,2,4,1
(D) 3,5,1,2,4

Q.10

Select the option that is related to the third word in the same way as the second word is related to the first word. (The words must be considered as meaningful English words and must NOT be related to each other based on the number of letters/number of consonants/vowels in the word) Goldsmith : Jewellery :: Cobbler : ?

(A) Plastic
(B) Shoes
(C) Rubber
(D) Leather

Q.11

Select the correct combination of mathematical signs to replace the * signs and to balance the given equation. 71*56*14*15*5

(A) +,÷,=,×
(B) ×,=,−,+
(C) +,−,=,×
(D) =, −,÷,×

Q.12

Study the given pattern carefully and select the number that can replace the question mark (?) in it. First row - 19, 81, 30 Second row - 42, 57, 107 Third row - 23, 45, ? (NOTE : Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding /deleting /multiplying etc. to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed)

(A) 75
(B) 82
(C) 54
(D) 66

Q.13

Select the option that is related to the fifth term in the same way as the second term is related to the first term and the fourth term is related to the third term. LEAN : NEAL :: MEAN : NEAM :: HEAR : ?

(A) HREA
(B) RHEA
(C) REAH
(D) RAEH

Q.14

Select the correct combination of mathematical signs to sequentially replace the * signs and to balance the given equation. 15 * 2 * 18 * 6 * 3 * 30

(A) ×, +, ÷, −, =

(B) ×, +, −, ÷, =

(C) +, ÷, −, ×, =

(D) ÷, −, ×, +, =

Q.16

If M denotes '−', N denotes '÷', O denotes '×' and P denotes '+', then what will come in place of '?' in the following equation? (81 N 27) O 4 M 21 P 72 P 3 M 3 O 9 = ?

(A) 35

(B) 29

(C) 42

(D) 39

Q.17

Select the correct combination of mathematical signs to replace the * signs and to balance the given equation. 19*4*44*59*61

(A) +,−,=,×

(B) ×,+,−,=

(C) +,×,−,=

(D) −,=,×,+

Q.19

Select the option that represents the letters that, when placed from left to right in the given blanks, will complete the letter series. _ T Z S S T _ Y S S T T _ S S _ T W _ S

(A) T X T T S

(B) X T X T T

(C) T T X T S

(D) T S X T S

Q.20

Select the option that is related to the fifth number in the same way as the second number is related to the first number and the fourth number is related to the third number. 5 :33 :: 11 : 141 :: 7 : ?

(A) 58

(B) 50

(C) 61

(D) 56

Q.21

Select the set in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following set. (17, 13, 68) (55, 46, 495) (NOTE : Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding /deleting /multiplying etc. to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is NOT allowed)

(A) (75, 69, 470)

(B) (45, 39, 270)

(C) (65, 59, 360)

(D) (55, 49, 310)

Q.22

Select the option that is related to the fifth number in the same way as the second number is related to the first number and the fourth number is related to the third number. 6 : 218::3 : 56::5 : ?

(A) 156

(B) 152

(C) 168

(D) 160

Q.24

Select the option that is related to the fourth term in the same way as the first term is related to the second term and the fifth term is related to the sixth term 7 : 512 :: ? : 2744 :: 15 : 4096

(A) 21

(B) 8

(C) 17

(D) 13

Q.25

In a certain code language, ‘FATHER’ is written as ‘REHTAF’, and ‘COUPLE’ is written as ‘ELPUOC’. How will ‘REMAIN’ be written in that language?

(A) NIAEMR
(B) NIAMER
(C) NAIEMR
(D) INAMER

Quantitative Aptitude 14 questions

Q.1

In an election that was contested by 2 candidates, one candidate got 20% of the total votes and yet lost by 600 votes. What is the total number of votes cast in the election, assuming all votes are valid?

(A) 900
(B) 700
(C) 800
(D) 1000

Q.2

Find the average of the numbers 61, 51, 41, 31, 21 and 11.

(A) 36
(B) 42
(C) 32
(D) 22

Q.3

20 workers can paint 24 walls in 36 days. In how many days can 30 workers paint 20 walls?

(A) 20
(B) 30
(C) 24
(D) 15

Q.10

An article is sold for ₹840 after two successive discounts of 20% and 30% on its marked price. What is the discount (in ₹)?

(A) 660
(B) 460
(C) 560
(D) 760

Q.11

The marked price of a mobile phone is 12% more than its cost price. If a discount of 8% is given on the marked price, then the gain per cent is:

(A) 2.92%
(B) 2.12%
(C) 3.04%
(D) 4.03%

Q.13

On a certain sum, the difference between the compound interest, compounded annually, and the simple interest at 10% per annum for 3 years is ₹93. The sum is:

(A) ₹3,500
(B) ₹3,000
(C) ₹4,000
(D) ₹2,500

Q.14

If the tax on a commodity is diminished by 20% and its consumption increased by 15%, the revenue decreases by:

(A) 8%
(B) 12%
(C) 10%
(D) 6%

Q.16

A train running at the speed of 63 km/h crosses a pole in 24 seconds. What is the length of the train?

(A) 360 m
(B) 320 m
(C) 280 m
(D) 420 m

Q.17
The maximum number of 4m × 50 cm × 20 cm slabs that may be stored in a 16m long, 12m wide, and 4m deep trench is:

(A) 1910
(B) 1890
(C) 1960
(D) 1920

Q.20
A girl travels 30 km at a speed of 15 km/h. She travels another 20 km at a speed of 10 km/h. What is her average speed for the entire journey?

(A) 15 km/h
(B) 12.5 km/h
(C) 13 km/h
(D) 11.5 km/h

Q.21
Find the 3rd proportional to 9 and 21.

(A) 49
(B) 12
(C) 30
(D) 81

Q.22
How many positive two-digit numbers can be divided by 6?

(A) 12
(B) 15
(C) 14
(D) 13

Q.23
The average score of a cricket team (of ten players and one captain) is 32. The scores of ten players are: 22, 11, 5, 34, 21, 32, 0, 28, 9 and 53. What is the score of the captain?

(A) 129
(B) 137
(C) 115
(D) 121

Q.25
Vishnu sold two items X and Y for ₹600 each, thereby gaining 20% on item X and losing 20% on item Y. Find his overall loss or gain percentage.

(A) Loss of 4%
(B) Gain of 4%
(C) Loss of 41.6%
(D) Loss or gain of 0%

General Awareness 23 questions

Q.1
Which of the following novels is written by Anita Desai?

(A) Clear Light of Day
(B) Jaya
(C) The White Tiger
(D) The Blue Umbrella

Q.2
Identify the correct formula to find the potential difference between two points.

(A) Q= 1/W
(B) W= Q/V
(C) V = Q/W
(D) V = W/Q

Q.3
A mentorship programme to train young authors named 'Young, Upcoming and Versatile Authors' (YUVA) scheme was launched in June 2021. Under the mentorship scheme, a consolidated scholarship of _____ per month was proposed to be paid for a period of six months per author.

(A) ₹45,000
(B) ₹30,000
(C) ₹25,000
(D) ₹50,000

Q.4

What type of climate do the two island regions of India, Lakshadweep and Andaman and Nicobar Islands experience?

(A) Humid subtropical climate
(B) Hot semi-arid climate
(C) Tropical warm climate
(D) Subtropical highland climate

Q.5

Who is the author of the historical book 'Delhi: A Novel'?

(A) Nayantara Sahgal
(B) Khushwant Singh
(C) Anita Desai
(D) Ahmed Ali

Q.6

Who among the following is India's only publicly well-known woman shehnai player?

(A) Gauhar Jaan
(B) Binodini Dasi
(C) Bageshwari Qamar
(D) Rasoolan Bai

Q.7

Manish Narwal is related to which of the following sports?

(A) Wrestling
(B) Badminton
(C) Cycling
(D) Shooting

Q.8

What type of farming is Kumari which is practiced in Western Ghats?

(A) Plantation farming
(B) Horticulture farming
(C) Intensive farming
(D) Primitive Subsistence farming

Q.9

Which of the following books was awarded the Booker Prize in 2021?

(A) The Promise
(B) No One Is Talking About This
(C) The Fortune Men
(D) A Passage North

Q.10

Who among the following won the US Open 2021 men's tennis singles final?

(A) Novak Djokovic
(B) Daniil Medvedev
(C) Lew Hoad
(D) Jack Crawford

Q.11

Which Emmy Award-nominated Indian choreographer has won the 10th Annual 'World Choreography Award 2020'?

(A) Suresh Mukund
(B) Shiamak Davar
(C) Prabhu Deva
(D) Ganesh Acharya

Q.12

When the commodity value of money is less than the monetary value of money, it is called _____.

(A) fiat money
(B) fiduciary money
(C) credit money
(D) full bodied money

Q.13

In February 2022, the Sports Authority of India (SAI) established a para centre under its National Centre of Excellence Scheme at which of the following SAI regional centres?

(A) Gandhinagar
(B) Lucknow
(C) Sonipat
(D) Kolkata

Q.14

The book 'Man Kautuhal' was compiled by which of the following kings of Medieval India?

(A) Raja Mansingh Tomar
(B) Krishna II
(C) Parantaka Viranarayana
(D) Rajashekhara Varman

Q.15

Why are species of moss used as fuel?

(A) Provide bituminous for energy
(B) Provide peat that have long been used as fuel
(C) Make a version of coal
(D) Help in geothermal energy

Q.16

Which of the following microscopic cells are of an amoeboid shape with a distinctive central membrane?

(A) Nerve cells
(B) White blood cells
(C) Guard cells
(D) Red blood cells

Q.17

Oleo gum resin (Asafoetida) can be obtained from:

(A) dried latex from the stem of ferula
(B) dried latex from the roots of mango tree
(C) dried latex from the banana leaves
(D) dried latex from the tap root of ferula

Q.18

Pandit Shivkumar Sharma is a classical _____ player.

(A) tabla
(B) santoor
(C) shehnai
(D) flute

Q.19

Who has the right to appoint an inter-state council to promote centre-state and inter-state cooperation?

(A) The President of India
(B) Both the President and Governor together
(C) Both the Prime Minister and Chief Minister together
(D) The Prime Minister of India

Q.20

Which algae produces agar?

(A) Gracilaria
(B) Chlorella
(C) Sargassum
(D) Align

Q.21

Which of the following dance types belong to the northern India?

(A) Kuchipudi
(B) Odissi
(C) Mohiniyattam
(D) Kathak

Q.23

Who was the first musician to be awarded the prestigious Bharat Ratna, India's highest civilian honour?

(A) Pt Hari Prasad Chaurasia
(B) M S Subbulakshmi
(C) Pt Ravi Shankar
(D) Begum Akhtar

Q.25

Shovana Narayan, a Padma Shri awardee, is a dancer of which of the following classical dance forms of India?

(A) Kathak
(B) Kathakali
(C) Bharatanatyam
(D) Manipuri

Answer key

English Language

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(A)**	Q.7 **(B)**	Q.8 **(D)**
Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.12 **(A)**	Q.13 **(D)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(B)**
Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(C)**	Q.19 **(A)**	Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(A)**
Q.22 **(B)**	Q.23 **(C)**	Q.24 **(B)**	Q.25 **(A)**		

General Intelligence

Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(C)**	Q.7 **(A)**	Q.9 **(A)**
Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(C)**	Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(A)**	Q.16 **(D)**
Q.17 **(B)**	Q.19 **(C)**	Q.20 **(C)**	Q.21 **(B)**	Q.22 **(B)**	Q.24 **(D)**
Q.25 **(B)**					

Quantitative Aptitude

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.13 **(B)**
Q.14 **(A)**	Q.16 **(D)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.20 **(B)**	Q.21 **(A)**	Q.22 **(B)**
Q.23 **(B)**	Q.25 **(A)**				

General Awareness

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(C)**
Q.13 **(A)**	Q.14 **(A)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(B)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.18 **(B)**
Q.19 **(A)**	Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.25 **(A)**	

Explanations

English Language

Q.1 · Answer (A) pull through

To 'pull through' is to recover from a serious illness; to 'pull over' is to bring a vehicle to the side of the road.

Q.4 · Answer (A) cupidity

'Cupidity' is greed, especially for money or possessions.

Q.5 · Answer (A) Instanteneous

The correct spelling is 'instantaneous'.

Q.6 · Answer (A) The mother loving looked

The verb 'looked' needs the adverb 'lovingly', not the adjective 'loving': 'The mother looked lovingly at her baby.'

Q.7 · Answer (B) flex, migrant, weather

A growing city 'flexes' (stretches) at its seams as it takes in a 'migrant' population, people who come for jobs and Bengaluru's pleasant 'weather'.

Q.8 · Answer (D) Concise

'Laconic' means using very few words: 'concise'.

Q.9 · Answer (C) Anarchy

Anarchy is a state of disorder in which there is no effective government or control.

Q.10 · Answer (A) Comfort

To 'annoy' is to irritate; its opposite is to 'comfort'. 'Miff', 'get' and 'ruffle' all mean to annoy.

Q.12 · Answer (A) heavily

The verb 'raining' is modified by an adverb, and nothing is being compared, so 'raining heavily'.

Q.13 · Answer (D) Penchant

A penchant is a strong liking or inclination for something.

Q.14 · Answer (D) Start entirely from the beginning

To 'start from scratch' is to begin again from the very beginning, building on nothing done before.

Q.15 · Answer (B) Modest

'Vain' means having too high an opinion of oneself; its opposite is 'modest'.

Q.16 · Answer (C) Where can the way to the library be found?

The object 'the way to the library' becomes the subject and 'can find' becomes 'can be found'; the agent 'by me' is dropped.

Q.17 · Answer (C) didn’t eat

'Did' is followed by the base form of the verb: 'They didn't eat anything yesterday.'

Q.18 · Answer (C) This novel was written by Premchand.

The simple past active 'wrote' becomes 'was written': 'This novel was written by Premchand.'

Q.19 · Answer (A) ADCB

A introduces Holi, D adds that it is also a festival of unity, C describes the first day (Holika Dahan) and B, opening 'Then on the next day', the second: ADCB.

Q.20 · Answer (A) Magnificent

'Resplendent' means splendid and dazzling in appearance: 'magnificent'.

Q.21 · Answer (A) chatter

When the host started to read, the 'chatter' (idle talk) of the audience stopped.

Q.22 · Answer (B) silence
Once the chatter stopped there was a 'silence', sweet because nobody forced it.

Q.23 · Answer (C) fidget
The listeners did not 'fidget' (move restlessly) or cough while each person read.

Q.24 · Answer (B) mumbled
Nervous and self-conscious, the writer 'mumbled' through the reading, as 'without making any sense of' it suggests.

Q.25 · Answer (A) poetry
Each person took a turn to read aloud, and of the options only 'poetry' is something read; music, dance and pottery are not.

General Intelligence

Q.3 · Answer (A) 267
The differences are 4, 11, 30, 67, that is $1^3 + 3$, $2^3 + 3$, $3^3 + 3$, $4^3 + 3$. The next is $5^3 + 3 = 128$: 139 + 128 = 267.

Q.4 · Answer (B) Only conclusion I follows
Some rectangles are decagons and all decagons are rhombuses, so some rectangles are rhombuses: some rhombuses are rectangles (I). Nothing links the hexagons to the decagons or the rhombuses, so II and III do not follow.

Q.5 · Answer (B) Son’s daughter
Her mother's daughter is the lady herself, and Harsh's wife's son is Harsh's son. So the lady's father is Harsh's son: she is his son's daughter.

Q.6 · Answer (C) MVOA
The first letters move +3 (G, J, M, P, S), the second +6 (J, P, V, B, H), the third +9 (W, F, O, X, G) and the fourth +12 (C, O, A, M, Y), wrapping round after Z: MVOA.

Q.7 · Answer (A) VDYH
Each letter moves 3 places forward: RATE → UDWH and RICH → ULFK. So SAVE → VDYH.

Q.9 · Answer (A) 3,5,2,4,1
A seed is sown, it grows into a plant, the plant bears fruit, the fruit is plucked and then eaten: Seed, Plant, Fruit, Pluck, Eat.

Q.10 · Answer (B) Shoes
A goldsmith makes jewellery; a cobbler makes and mends shoes.

Q.11 · Answer (A) +,÷,=,×
71 + 56 ÷ 14 = 15 × 5: 71 + 4 = 75.

Q.12 · Answer (C) 54
In each row the third number is 3 times the first minus a third of the second: 3 × 19 – 81 ÷ 3 = 57 – 27 = 30 and 3 × 42 – 57 ÷ 3 = 126 – 19 = 107. So 3 × 23 – 45 ÷ 3 = 69 – 15 = 54.

Q.13 · Answer (C) REAH
The first and last letters swap: LEAN → NEAL and MEAN → NEAM. So HEAR → REAH.

Q.14 · Answer (A) ×, +, ÷, –, =
15 × 2 + 18 ÷ 6 – 3 = 30: 30 + 3 – 3 = 30.

Q.16 · Answer (D) 39
(81 ÷ 27) × 4 – 21 + 72 + 3 – 3 × 9 = 12 – 21 + 72 + 3 – 27 = 39.

Q.17 · Answer (B) ×,+,–,=
19 × 4 + 44 – 59 = 61: 76 + 44 – 59 = 61.

Q.19 · Answer (C) T T X T S
With T, T, X, T, S in the blanks the series is TTZSS TTYSS TTXSS TTWSS: TT and SS round a middle letter that moves back one each time.

Q.20 · Answer (C) 61
The second number is the square of one more than the first, minus 3: $6^2 - 3 = 33$ and $12^2 - 3 = 141$. Likewise $8^2 - 3 = 61$.

Q.21 · Answer (B) (45, 39, 270)
The third number is the first times the difference of the first two: $(17 - 13) \times 17 = 68$ and $(55 - 46) \times 55 = 495$. Likewise $(45 - 39) \times 45 = 270$.

Q.22 · Answer (B) 152
The second number is 6 times the square of the first, plus 2: $6 \times 36 + 2 = 218$ and $6 \times 9 + 2 = 56$. Likewise $6 \times 25 + 2 = 152$.

Q.24 · Answer (D) 13
Each number is paired with the cube of one more than itself: $512 = 8^3$ (7 + 1) and $4096 = 16^3$ (15 + 1). $2744 = 14^3$, so the missing number is 13.

Q.25 · Answer (B) NIAMER
Each word is written in reverse: FATHER → REHTAF and COUPLE → ELPUOC. So REMAIN → NIAMER.

Quantitative Aptitude

Q.1 · Answer (D) 1000
The loser got 20% and the winner 80%, a margin of 60% of the votes. 60% = 600, so 1,000 votes were cast.

Q.2 · Answer (A) 36
$(61 + 51 + 41 + 31 + 21 + 11)/6 = 216/6 = 36$.

Q.3 · Answer (A) 20
24 walls take $20 \times 36 = 720$ worker-days, so one wall takes 30. 20 walls take 600 worker-days: 600/30 = 20 days for 30 workers.

Q.10 · Answer (A) 660
After 20% and then 30% off, $0.8 \times 0.7 = 0.56$ of the marked price is left: marked price = 840/0.56 = ₹1,500, so the discount is 1,500 − 840 = ₹660.

Q.11 · Answer (C) 3.04%
On a cost price of 100 the marked price is 112 and the selling price $112 \times 0.92 = 103.04$: a gain of 3.04%.

Q.13 · Answer (B) ₹3,000
For 3 years, CI − SI = $P(r/100)^2(3 + r/100) = P \times 0.01 \times 3.1 = 0.031P$. $0.031P = 93$, so P = ₹3,000.

Q.14 · Answer (A) 8%
Revenue = tax × consumption: $0.8 \times 1.15 = 0.92$, a fall of 8%.

Q.16 · Answer (D) 420 m
63 km/h = $63 \times 5/18 = 17.5$ m/s. Passing a pole, the train covers its own length: $17.5 \times 24 = 420$ m.

Q.17 · Answer (D) 1920
The slabs fit exactly: 16/4 = 4 along the length, 12/0.5 = 24 across and 4/0.2 = 20 deep, so $4 \times 24 \times 20 = 1{,}920$ slabs (768 $m^3 \div 0.4$ m^3).

Q.20 · Answer (B) 12.5 km/h
Time = 30/15 + 20/10 = 4 hours for 50 km: 50/4 = 12.5 km/h.

Q.21 · Answer (A) 49
The third proportional x satisfies $9 : 21 = 21 : x$, so $x = 21^2/9 = 441/9 = 49$.

Q.22 · Answer (B) 15
The two-digit multiples of 6 run from 12 (6 × 2) to 96 (6 × 16): 16 – 2 + 1 = 15.

Q.23 · Answer (B) 137
The 11 scores total 11 × 32 = 352. The ten players' scores add up to 215, so the captain scored 352 – 215 = 137.

Q.25 · Answer (A) Loss of 4%
Cost prices: 600/1.2 = ₹500 and 600/0.8 = ₹750, ₹1,250 in all, against sales of ₹1,200. Loss = 50/1,250 = 4%.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (A) Clear Light of Day
'Clear Light of Day' (1980) is Anita Desai's novel. 'The White Tiger' is by Aravind Adiga and 'The Blue Umbrella' by Ruskin Bond.

Q.2 · Answer (D) V = W/Q
The potential difference between two points is the work done in moving a unit charge between them: V = W/Q.

Q.3 · Answer (D) ₹50,000
Under the Ministry of Education's PM-YUVA mentorship scheme, each selected author was to receive ₹50,000 a month for six months.

Q.4 · Answer (C) Tropical warm climate
Lying in the tropics and surrounded by the sea, both island groups are warm and humid all year round, with little seasonal change in temperature.

Q.5 · Answer (B) Khushwant Singh
Khushwant Singh's 'Delhi: A Novel' (1990) tells the city's history through the centuries. Ahmed Ali wrote 'Twilight in Delhi'.

Q.6 · Answer (C) Bageshwari Qamar
SSC's key gives Bageshwari Qamar. Gauhar Jaan and Rasoolan Bai were singers and Binodini Dasi a stage actress, not shehnai players.

Q.7 · Answer (D) Shooting
Manish Narwal is a para pistol shooter; he won gold in the mixed 50 m pistol SH1 event at the Tokyo 2020 Paralympics.

Q.8 · Answer (D) Primitive Subsistence farming
Kumari is the Western Ghats name for slash-and-burn (shifting) cultivation, a form of primitive subsistence farming; in the north-east it is called jhumming.

Q.9 · Answer (A) The Promise
Damon Galgut's 'The Promise' won the 2021 Booker Prize; the other three were on that year's shortlist.

Q.10 · Answer (B) Daniil Medvedev
Daniil Medvedev beat Novak Djokovic in the 2021 US Open final for his first Grand Slam title.

Q.11 · Answer (A) Suresh Mukund
Suresh Mukund, founder of the Mumbai dance crew Kings United, won the World Choreography Award 2020 for his work on the television show World of Dance.

Q.12 · Answer (C) credit money
SSC's key gives credit money: in the usual textbook classification, money whose value as money is greater than its value as a commodity (paper notes, token coins) is credit money, while full-bodied money's two values are equal. Fiat money also has little commodity value, but it is defined by being issued on the government's order, not by this comparison.

Q.13 · Answer (A) Gandhinagar
SAI set up the para centre at its Gandhinagar regional centre, for para athletics, swimming, powerlifting and table tennis.

Q.14 · Answer (A) Raja Mansingh Tomar
'Man Kautuhal', a treatise on music, was compiled under Raja Man Singh Tomar of Gwalior (1486-1516), a great patron of dhrupad.

Q.15 · Answer (B) Provide peat that have long been used as fuel
Sphagnum moss builds up in bogs as peat, which is dried and burnt as fuel.

Q.16 · Answer (B) White blood cells
White blood cells can change shape and move like an amoeba; red blood cells are biconcave discs, guard cells are bean-shaped and nerve cells are long and branched.

Q.17 · Answer (D) dried latex from the tap root of ferula
Asafoetida (hing) is the dried latex that oozes from cuts in the thick tap root of Ferula plants.

Q.18 · Answer (B) santoor
Pandit Shivkumar Sharma made the santoor, a hammered string instrument from Kashmir, an instrument of the classical concert stage.

Q.19 · Answer (A) The President of India
Under Article 263 the President may establish an Inter-State Council to advise on disputes and subjects of common interest between the states and the Centre.

Q.20 · Answer (A) Gracilaria
Agar is extracted from red algae such as Gracilaria and Gelidium. Chlorella is a green alga and Sargassum a brown one.

Q.21 · Answer (D) Kathak
Kathak comes from northern India; Kuchipudi is from Andhra Pradesh, Odissi from Odisha and Mohiniyattam from Kerala.

Q.23 · Answer (B) M S Subbulakshmi
The Carnatic singer M S Subbulakshmi received the Bharat Ratna in 1998, the first musician to do so; Ravi Shankar followed in 1999.

Q.25 · Answer (A) Kathak
Shovana Narayan is a leading exponent of Kathak.

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